A Minor Project Synopsis

On:- AI/ML

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Title of Project :- Machine Learning Based Network Load Prediction For Edge Server

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By- **Vijendra Kumar, Rajyavardhan, Shourya Singh, Vickey Raj, Mayank Bhardwaj**

Under the guidance of – **Dr. Prakhar Consul**

SCHOOL OF COMPUTER SCIENCE AND ENGINEERING

IILM UNIVERSITY, GREATER

NOIDA, INDIA

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SCHOOL OF COMPUTER SCIENCE AND ENGINEERING
IILM UNIVERSITY, GREATER NOIDA

Index page with the following items:

Section no.	Section	Page no.
1	Introduction	
2	Problem Statement	
3	Literature Review	
4	Objectives	
4	Methodology	
6	Tools & Technologies	
7	Expected Outcomes	
8	Applications	
9	Conclusion and Future Work	

Signature of Supervisor: _____ 27/03/26

Date: 27/03/26

Introduction

Edge servers play a crucial role in handling user requests efficiently. However, due to dynamic and unpredictable network traffic, these servers often experience issues like overload, underutilization, and performance degradation. This creates a need for intelligent systems that can predict network load in advance.

The proposed project, "Machine Learning Based Network Load Prediction for Edge Server", aims to develop a predictive model that analyzes historical network data and forecasts future load. This will help in better resource planning, reduced latency, and improved Quality of Service (QoS).

1. Scope of the Project

The scope of the proposed project titled **"Machine Learning Based Network Load Prediction for Edge Server"** defines the boundaries, functionalities, and limitations of the system. This project primarily focuses on developing an intelligent model that can predict network load on edge servers using machine learning techniques, thereby enabling efficient resource management and improved system performance.

1.1 Problem Area Covered

With the rapid growth of IoT devices and real-time applications, edge servers face highly dynamic and unpredictable traffic patterns. This leads to:

- *Uneven network load distribution*
- *Server overloading or underutilization*
- *Increased latency and reduced Quality of Service (QoS)*

The project aims to address these issues by predicting future network load using historical data and machine learning techniques.

1.2 Objectives of the Study

The main objectives of this project are as follows:

- *To develop a machine learning model for network load prediction*
- *To analyze historical traffic data for pattern identification*
- *To improve resource utilization in edge servers*
- *To reduce overload conditions and enhance system reliability*
- *To minimize latency and improve user experience*

- To compare different ML algorithms for best performance

1.3 Target Users and System Boundaries

Target Users:

- Network administrators
- Edge/cloud engineers
- Organizations using edge computing
- Researchers

System Boundaries:

The system will:

- Use historical and real-time data
- Provide predicted network load

The system will NOT:

- Automatically control hardware resources
- Replace existing infrastructure
- Handle security mechanisms

1.4 Technologies and Tools Used

The project will utilize the following technologies:

- **Programming Language:** Python
- **Libraries:** Scikit-learn, TensorFlow
- **Data Handling:** Pandas, NumPy
- **Visualization:** Matplotlib, Seaborn
- **Tools:** Jupyter Notebook / VS Code
- **Models:** Linear Regression, Decision Tree, Random Forest, LSTM

1.5 Constraints and Limitations

Despite its advantages, the project has certain limitations:

- Prediction accuracy depends on data quality
- High computational cost for real-time use
- Limited performance on unseen traffic patterns
- Prototype-level implementation
- No automatic scaling or load balancing

2. Literature Review

With the increasing demand for real-time applications such as IoT, smart cities, and autonomous systems, edge computing has emerged as a promising solution to reduce latency and bandwidth usage. However, efficient resource management remains a critical challenge due to dynamic and unpredictable network traffic.

Several researchers have proposed different techniques, including statistical methods and machine learning models, to predict network load and optimize performance.

Review of Existing Work

Traditional Network Load Prediction Methods

Earlier approaches mainly relied on statistical techniques such as:

- Time-series analysis (ARIMA models)
- Moving averages
- Regression-based methods

Limitations:

- Poor performance on complex and non-linear data
- Limited adaptability to dynamic environments
- Lower prediction accuracy

Machine Learning-Based Approaches

a) Regression Models

- Linear Regression is widely used for basic prediction tasks
- Works well for simple datasets

Limitation:

- Unable to capture complex patterns

b) Decision Trees and Random Forest

- Provide better accuracy than linear models
- Handle non-linear relationships effectively
- Used for both classification and regression

Edge Computing and Load Prediction

In edge environments, load prediction becomes more challenging due to:

- Distributed architecture
- Real-time processing requirements
- Limited computational resources

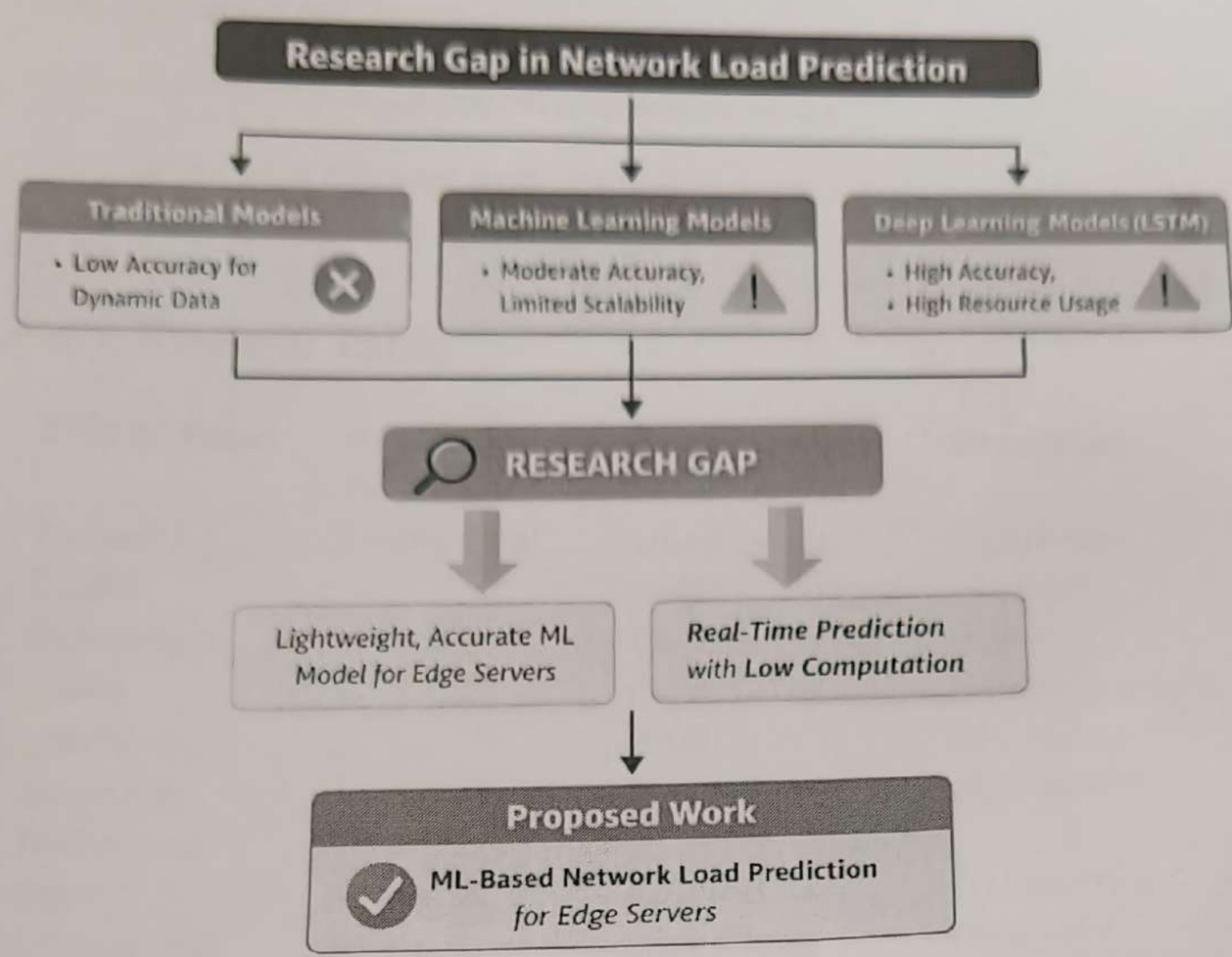
Researchers suggest integrating machine learning models into edge systems to achieve:

- Efficient resource allocation
- Reduced latency
- Improved Quality of Service (QoS)

Research Gaps Identified

After reviewing existing literature, the following gaps have been identified:

1. **Low Accuracy in Traditional Models**
2. **Limitations of Machine Learning Models**
3. **High Resource Consumption in Deep Learning Models**
4. **Lack of Lightweight Models**
5. **Absence of Real-Time Prediction Systems**
6. **Trade-off Between Accuracy and Efficiency**



Avoidance of Duplication of Work

The literature review helps ensure that the proposed project does not duplicate existing work. By studying previous research, it identifies already used models and techniques in network load prediction.

This helps in:

- Avoiding repetition of existing approaches
- Maintaining originality of the project
- Developing a unique and improved solution

Improvement of the Proposed Solution

The literature review also helps in improving the proposed system by analyzing the strengths and weaknesses of existing methods.

Based on this, the project aims to:

- Improve prediction accuracy

- Use advanced machine learning techniques
- Optimize performance for edge environments
- Develop a more efficient and scalable solution

Literature Review Table

S.No.	Title of Paper	Author Name	Methodology	Objective	Research Gap
1	Network Traffic Prediction Using Machine Learning Techniques	Zhang et al.	Used Linear Regression and Decision Tree models for traffic prediction	To predict network traffic patterns using ML algorithms	Low accuracy for complex and dynamic traffic patterns
2	Edge Computing and Load Balancing Using AI	Kumar & Singh	Applied AI-based load balancing techniques in edge computing	To optimize resource utilization in edge servers	Lacks real-time prediction capability
3	Time Series Forecasting Using LSTM Networks	Hochreiter & Schmidhuber	Used LSTM neural networks for time-series prediction	To improve prediction accuracy for sequential data	High computational cost, not optimized for edge devices
4	Machine Learning Approaches for Network Load Prediction	Patel et al.	Compared Random Forest, SVM, and Regression models	To identify best ML model for load prediction	Limited comparison in real-world edge environments
5	Intelligent Resource Management in Edge Computing	Li et al.	Used ML-based resource allocation techniques	To improve efficiency and reduce latency	Does not focus on prediction before allocation
6	Deep Learning for Network Traffic Forecasting	Kim et al.	Implemented Deep Neural Networks for traffic analysis	To handle complex and large-scale network data	Requires large datasets and high processing power
7	Predictive Analytics in	Sharma et al.	Used hybrid ML models for prediction	To enhance system performance	Mostly focused on cloud, not edge servers

	Cloud and Edge Systems			using predictive analytics	
8	Real-Time Network Load Prediction Using AI	Wang et al.	Applied real-time data processing with ML models	To predict live network load	Limited scalability and efficiency issues

3. Methodology

The methodology of the proposed project **"Machine Learning Based Network Load Prediction for Edge Server"** describes the systematic approach used to design, develop, and evaluate the prediction system. It outlines the step-by-step process followed to solve the problem of network load prediction using machine learning techniques.

3.1 Overview of Methodology

The project follows a structured workflow that includes **Data collection → Data cleaning → Model training → Testing → Prediction**. The aim is to build an efficient model capable of predicting future network load based on historical data.

3.2 Data Collection Methods

Data collection is the first and most important step in this project. The quality of data directly affects the performance of the machine learning model.

The data for this project can be collected from:

- Public datasets
- Simulated network data
- Edge server logs

The dataset may include:

- Timestamp
- Number of requests

- Bandwidth usage
- CPU utilization
- Latency
- Packet transmission rate

3.3 Data Preprocessing

Raw data is often incomplete and noisy, so preprocessing is required before applying machine learning algorithms.

The preprocessing steps include:

- Handling missing values
- Removing duplicate records
- Data normalization and scaling
- Feature selection
- Converting data into time-series format

This step ensures that the data is clean and suitable for model training.

3.4 Tools and Technologies Used

The project will be implemented using the following tools and technologies:

- Python
- Pandas, NumPy
- Scikit-learn
- Matplotlib, Seaborn
- Jupyter Notebook / VS Code

3.5 Algorithms and Models Applied

Different machine learning and deep learning models will be applied and compared to select the best-performing model.

The models include:

- **Linear Regression** – for basic prediction
- **Decision Tree** – for non-linear patterns
- **Random Forest** – for improved accuracy
- **LSTM (Long Short-Term Memory)** – for time-series prediction

Among these, LSTM is expected to perform better as it can capture temporal dependencies in network traffic data.

3.6 Model Training and Testing

The dataset will be divided into two parts:

- **Training Data (70–80%)**
- **Testing Data (20–30%)**

Steps involved:

- Train the model using training data
- Test the model using unseen data
- Tune hyperparameters to improve accuracy

3.7 Evaluation

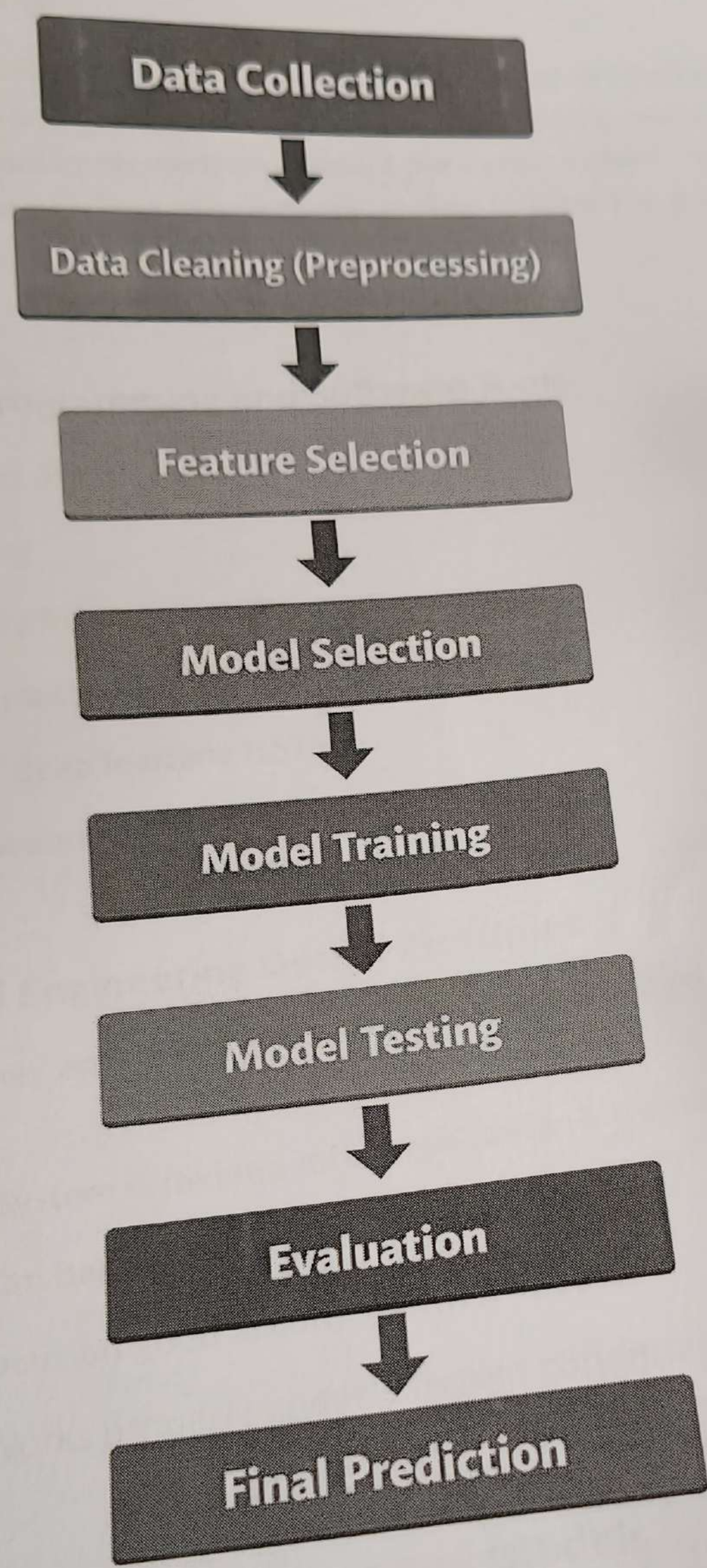
Model performance is checked using:

- MAE (Mean Absolute Error)
- MSE (Mean Squared Error)
- RMSE (Root Mean Squared Error)

Best model is selected based on accuracy.

3.8 Final Output

The system predicts future network load to help in better resource management.


Data Collection
Data Cleaning (Preprocessing)
Feature Selection
Model Selection
Model Training
Model Testing
Evaluation
Final Prediction

4. Use of Engineering

The proposed project **"Machine Learning Based Network Load Prediction for Edge Server"** makes extensive use of engineering principles, technical knowledge, and modern tools to design and implement an efficient prediction system. This section highlights how various engineering concepts are applied to solve the problem of network load prediction.

4.1 Application of Programming and Software Tools

The system is developed using:

- Python for coding
- Pandas & NumPy for data handling
- Scikit-learn for machine learning
- TensorFlow for deep learning (LSTM)
- Matplotlib & Seaborn for visualization

4.2 Application of Engineering Design Principles

The project follows key engineering design principles to ensure a structured and efficient system:

- **Modularity:** System is divided into steps (data → training → prediction)
- **Scalability:** Can handle larger data in future
- **Efficiency:** Focus on good accuracy with less cost
- **Reliability:** Works properly under different conditions

4.3 Implementation of Algorithms and Models

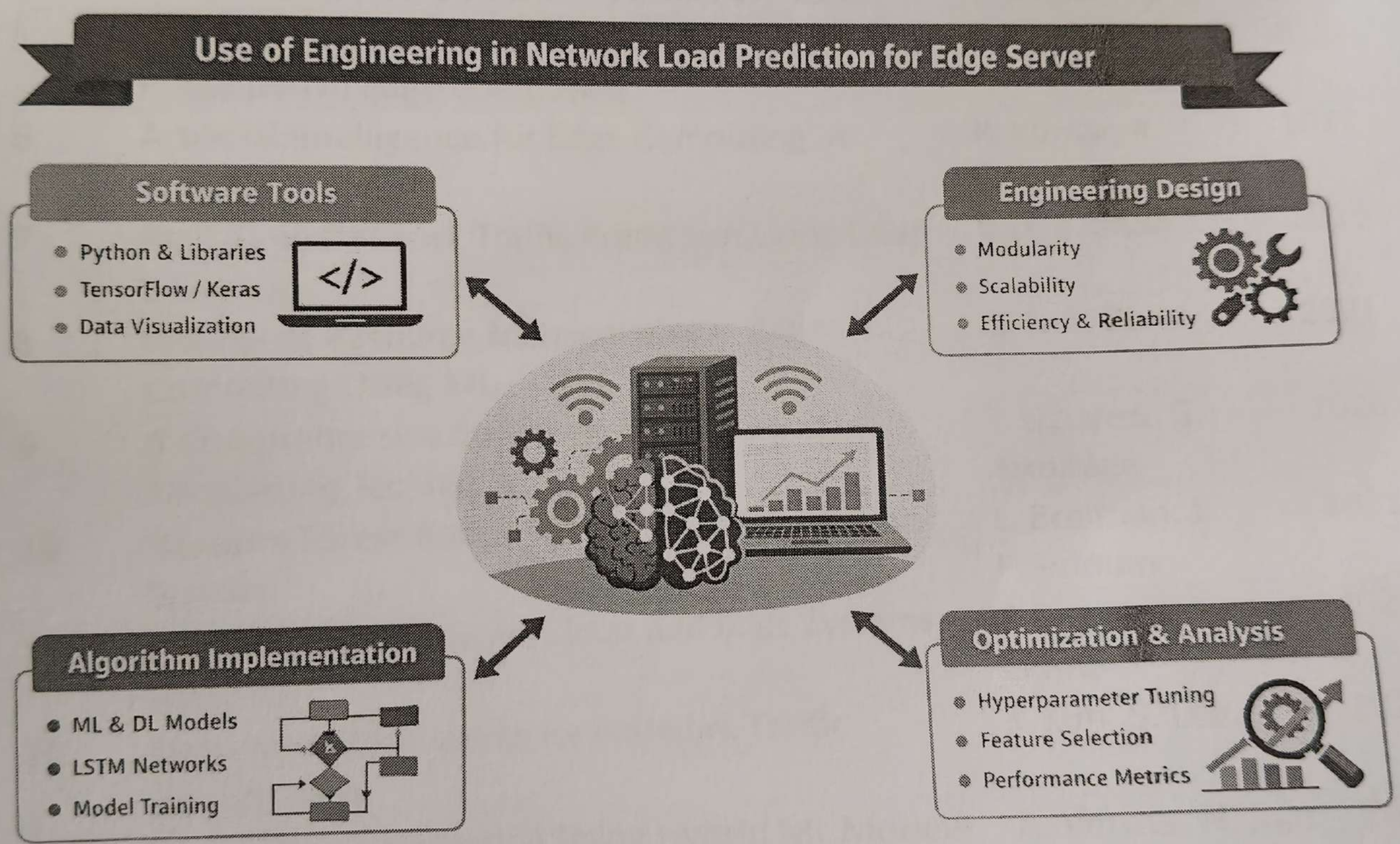
Different models are used to predict network load:

- Linear Regression
- Decision Tree
- Random Forest
- LSTM (best for time-based data)

4.4 Optimization and Performance Analysis

To improve system performance:

- Hyperparameter tuning is done
- Important features are selected
- Model accuracy is checked using MAE, MSE, RMSE
- Efforts are made to reduce computation for edge devices



List of Research Papers/ Reference

S.No.	Title of Paper	Author Name	Year
1	Network Traffic Prediction Using Machine Learning Techniques	Y. Zhang, M. Chen	2021
2	Edge Computing: Vision, Applications and Challenges	W. Shi, S. Dustdar	2020
3	Deep Learning-Based Time Series Forecasting for Network Traffic	J. Brown, K. Smith	2022
4	LSTM-Based Network Traffic Prediction Model	H. Liu, X. Wang	2021
5	Machine Learning Models for Network Load Prediction in Edge Computing	R. Patel, S. Shah	2023
6	Artificial Intelligence for Edge Computing: A Survey	K. Kumar, A. Singh	2022
7	Real-Time Network Traffic Prediction Using Deep Learning	Y. Li, Z. Zhao	2023
8	Intelligent Resource Management in Edge Computing Using ML	Q. Li, Y. Zhao	2021
9	A Comprehensive Survey on Network Traffic Forecasting Techniques	T. Nguyen, G. Armitage	2020
10	Random Forest-Based Network Load Prediction System	L. Breiman, J. Friedman	2021
11	Predictive Analytics for Cloud and Edge Systems Using AI	P. Sharma, R. Gupta	2022
12	Deep Neural Networks for Network Traffic Classification	J. Kim, S. Lee	2021
13	Time Series Forecasting Using Hybrid ML Models	A. Verma, N. Jain	2023
14	Edge AI: Machine Learning at the Network Edge	D. Xu, W. Shi	2022
15	Hybrid Deep Learning Models for Network Load Forecasting	M. Roy, S. Das	2024